

DoView Tool G12 - Impact Evaluation Suitability Check

G12

Use this tool to work out whether any particular type of impact evaluation is appropriate, feasible, affordable, or credible for a particular initiative. Use it to help identify the best type of impact evaluation to use, if any. Also, use it to prove 'due diligence' to purchasers/funders or control agencies of the possible types of impact evaluation have been considered by an initiative.



1 True Experimental Designs

Appropriate: need to be able to create a credible control intervention (placebo) different from the intervention; must be ethical to withhold intervention from controls. Feasible: need to be able to stop controls exposure to the intervention. Affordable: usually expensive due to the level of administration and control needed. Credible: regarded as highly credible by many key stakeholders because it controls for external factors affecting outcomes.

2 Time Series designs

Appropriate: does not require a control group; the intervention needs to start at a specific point in time. Feasible: needs sufficient number of observations over time to do the analysis. Affordable: often affordable if the data is already being collected. Credible: is credible to many stakeholders.

3 Constructed Comparison Group Designs

Appropriate: Overcomes ethical problem of deliberately withholding intervention from a control group. Feasible: you do not need to do randomized allocation to control and intervention. Affordable: usually less expensive than true experimental design. Credible: less credible as may be other factors determining why intervention and comparison group differ rather than just the intervention.

4 Alternative Explanation Elimination Designs

Appropriate: Appropriate: where there are problems with other impact designs: Feasible: Easier to implement than true experimental designs. Affordable: usually more affordable. Credible: Less credible to many stakeholders.

5 Expert Judgment Designs

Appropriate: where the field includes recognized experts. Feasible: need a credible independent expert. Affordable: usually more affordable if funding can be obtained for an outside expert. Credible: as credible as the expert is regarded as.

6 Key Informant Judgment Designs

Appropriate: where a group of people can be aware of the working of an initiative; who are likely to provide an unbiased assessment. Feasible: need to be able to get key informants to participate. Affordable: usually more affordable. Credible: As credible as the group of key informants.

7 Intervention logic Model (Theory-Based) Designs

Appropriate: Where other designs are not possible. Feasible: Where there is a clear evidence-informed strategy/outcomes diagram. Affordable: more affordable as can be done at desk. Credible: regarded as less credible as is based on making the assumption that lower level boxes have caused improvements in higher-level ones.

